WEEK 4 · LESSON 19 OF 24 · HANDOUT

Privacy and Data Protection

Study time: **about 40 minutes** (reading, video and activity)

Your goal in this lesson: Know what information must never go into AI tools, understand the basics of Rwanda's personal-data law, and use AI safely at work.

What happens to what you type

When you type into an AI tool, your text travels to the company's servers. Depending on the tool and your settings, it may be stored, reviewed for safety, or used to improve future models. **Treat anything you type into a public AI tool as if it could be seen by others.**

Never paste these into a public AI tool

- National ID numbers, passport numbers, bank or card details, passwords and PINs.
- Medical information about yourself or others.
- Other people's personal data: names together with phone numbers, addresses, salaries, grades.
- Confidential business information: contracts, unreleased plans, client lists, internal finances.
- Anything your employer or institution has told you not to share.

Rwanda's personal-data law

Rwanda has a law protecting personal data: **Law N° 058/2021 of 13/10/2021 relating to the protection of personal data and privacy**. In simple terms, it means:

- Personal data must be collected and used **for a clear, lawful purpose**, and only as much as needed.
- People have rights over their data — for example to know how it is used and to ask for corrections.
- Organisations that handle personal data must **protect it** and follow registration and security rules overseen by the national supervisory authority (the National Cyber Security Authority).

For you this means: if your job involves customers', patients', students' or citizens' data, **pasting it into an AI tool without permission could break the law and your employer's rules**, not just good practice.

Safe ways to still get help

- **Anonymise**: replace names and numbers with placeholders ("Customer A", "0700 000 000").
- **Use sample data**: get the formula, template or structure using made-up data, then apply it yourself.
- **Use approved tools**: many organisations provide business versions with stronger privacy settings. Use what your employer approves.
- **Check settings**: many tools let you turn off chat history or training on your data.

Protecting your accounts

- Use a strong password and two-step verification on your AI accounts.

- Be careful with browser extensions and unknown "AI" apps that ask for broad access to your email or files.
- Watch for AI-powered scams: realistic fake emails, voice messages and videos. Verify unusual requests for money through a second channel.

Remember this: Keep personal and confidential data out of public AI tools, respect Rwanda's data-protection law, and anonymise when you need help.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Activity

Task 1

Take a real work or study task that involves personal data (for example, a list of customers who owe money).

Task 2

Rewrite the task using **anonymised or made-up data** so you can safely ask AI for help.

Task 3

Check the privacy settings of the AI tool you use most: can you turn off history or training? Write down what you changed.

Task 4

Write a 5-rule "AI privacy checklist" for your workplace, class or club.

Self-check

Think about your answers here, then take the quiz online — it is marked instantly and explains every answer.

1. How should you treat text you type into a public AI tool?
   - A. As automatically deleted
   - B. As completely private forever
   - C. As legally protected in every case
   - D. As if it could be stored or seen by others
2. Which of these must you NEVER paste into a public AI tool?
   - A. A list of customers' names with phone numbers and debts
   - B. A public news article
   - C. A recipe
   - D. A famous quote
3. Which law protects personal data in Rwanda?
   - A. The Road Traffic Law
   - B. There is no such law
   - C. The Labour Code only
   - D. Law Nº 058/2021 relating to the protection of personal data and privacy
4. What does it mean to ANONYMISE data before asking AI for help?
   - A. Delete the data
   - B. Send it by email instead
   - C. Replace names and numbers with placeholders or fake values
   - D. Translate it to French
5. Your employer provides an approved AI tool with business privacy settings. What should you do?
   - A. Share your password with colleagues
   - B. Ignore it and use any tool
   - C. Turn off all security
   - D. Use the approved tool for work tasks
6. You get a voice message that sounds like your manager urgently asking for money. What is the safe response?
   - A. Reply with your PIN
   - B. Forward it to all contacts
   - C. Verify the request through a second, trusted channel first
   - D. Send the money quickly

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